

# Eunsun Kim

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| Education          | University of California, Los Angeles, Ph.D. in Quantitative Marketing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Expected 2027 |
|                    | Duke University, M.S. in Economics and Computation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | 2021          |
|                    | Seoul National University, M.S. in Quantitative Marketing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2019          |
|                    | Seoul National University, B.A. in Business<br><i>summa cum laude</i> ; Minor in Economics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 2017          |
| Research Interests | Quantitative Marketing, Empirical Industrial Organization, AI and Algorithmic Pricing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |               |
| Job Market Paper   | <b>Following to Lead: Dominant Followership in Sequential Price Competition</b><br>The nature of retail price competition is changing as firms increasingly delegate pricing decisions to algorithms that condition prices on rivals' price changes. Using synchronized high-frequency cross-platform pricing data that track identical products, I find that Amazon, despite being the dominant platform, stands out as an effective follower. I investigate this strategy, which I call dominant followership, as a mechanism through which demand asymmetry softens price competition. A sequential Bertrand model modified to break ties in favor of the dominant firm explains why this mechanism can be incentive-compatible. Because a dominant firm retains a majority of demand at price parity, it has less incentive to undercut a smaller rival and may instead prefer to match the rival's higher price. Anticipating this response, the rival can profitably initiate price increases that would otherwise be difficult to sustain. The mechanism requires a timing friction: if the rival cannot immediately adjust again, the dominant firm's matching response can keep prices above the standard simultaneous-move Nash equilibrium level. When pricing is delegated to adaptive algorithms, the same demand and timing asymmetries shape not only current pricing incentives, but also what rivals learn from market feedback. Prices rise only when the dominant firm is also the effective responder: demand asymmetry makes matching profitable, while response timing makes that matching part of the rival's learning environment. The dominant firm's predictable response reinforces rival-initiated price increases that would otherwise be penalized by lost demand. The main takeaway of this paper is that modern algorithmic pricing should be modeled as a sequential response process: when systematic responses become learnable by rivals, individually incentive-compatible pricing decisions can turn into competition-softening outcomes without explicit coordination. |               |
| Working Papers     | <b>Can Consumer AI Discipline Algorithmic Pricing?</b><br>This project studies whether consumer-side AI shopping agents can weaken dominant-platform pricing power in markets where firms use pricing algorithms. Many consumers begin product search inside a dominant platform and compare only a limited set of alternatives, allowing firms to benefit from search frictions and default position. AI shopping agents can change this environment by searching across platforms, tracking recent price histories, and making price and non-price tradeoffs easier to compare. However, lower search costs need not eliminate platform advantage, because consumers may still value the dominant platform's non-price advantages, such as delivery speed, return convenience, and trust. I model consumer-side AI as lowering search frictions and expanding consumers' consideration sets, which reduces the dominant firm's demand advantage. Starting from a market in which the dominant platform captures a large share of demand, I ask how pricing incentives change as AI agents make consumers more willing to consider rival sellers. The main exercise is a threshold analysis: how much must the dominant firm's demand advantage fall before the dominant-followership mechanism breaks down? I then examine the implications for consumer welfare. The project speaks to a policy question in algorithmic pricing: whether consumer-side AI can discipline dominant platforms through better search, or whether dominant-platform advantages are too persistent for the market to self-correct.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |               |

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|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| <b>Honors and Research Grants</b> | AMA-Sheth Consortium Fellow                                                           | 2026         |
|                                   | NBER Digital Economics and AI Tutorial                                                | 2025         |
|                                   | Haring Symposium Fellow                                                               | 2025         |
|                                   | ISMS Doctoral Consortium Fellow                                                       | 2023, 2025   |
|                                   | Price Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation Research Grant                       | 2024         |
|                                   | Grand Prize, Mock Fair Trade Commission Contest, Korea Fair Trade Commission          | 2017         |
|                                   | Dean's List, Seoul National University Business School                                | 2015, 2016   |
| <b>Presentations</b>              | <b>Following to Lead: Dominant Followership in Sequential Price Competition</b>       |              |
|                                   | Industrial Organization Proseminar, Department of Economics, UCLA                     | 2025, 2026   |
|                                   | World Congress of the Econometric Society (ESWC)                                      | 2025         |
|                                   | ISMS Marketing Science Conference                                                     | 2025         |
|                                   | Artificial Intelligence in Management (AIM) Conference                                | 2025         |
| <b>Discussions</b>                | Haring Symposium                                                                      | 2025         |
|                                   | California Quantitative Marketing Ph.D. Student Conference                            | 2023, 2024   |
| <b>Teaching Experience</b>        | Teaching Assistant, UCLA Anderson School of Management                                | 2022–present |
|                                   | Customer Assessment and Analytics (MBA elective), Brett Hollenbeck, Robert Zeithammer |              |
|                                   | Data and Decisions (MFE course), H. Tai Lam                                           |              |
|                                   | Statistical Foundations for Data Analytics (MSBA course), Peter Rossi                 |              |
|                                   | Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science, Duke University                   | 2021         |
|                                   | Everything Data                                                                       |              |
|                                   | Graduate Assistant, Center for Data and Visualization Sciences, Duke University       | 2020         |
|                                   | Teaching Assistant, Seoul National University Business School                         | 2018–2019    |
|                                   | Data-Driven Marketing Analytics                                                       |              |
|                                   | Marketing Management                                                                  |              |
| <b>Past Employment</b>            | Mobile Market Research Team, LG Display                                               | 2017         |
|                                   | Intern, Corporate Law Team, Barun Law LLC                                             | 2015         |
| <b>Programming</b>                | Python, R, MATLAB, C++, $\text{\LaTeX}$                                               |              |

## REFERENCES

For letters of recommendation, please contact amy.corrales@anderson.ucla.edu.

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